

Nathan Ayele

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Dear Members of the Rank and Tenure Committee,

It is my great honor to write this letter of support for Professor Vlad Veksler's rank and tenure promotion portfolio at Caldwell University. As a former student who benefited directly from his instruction, mentorship, and academic leadership, I can speak with complete confidence to the profound impact he has on his students and the broader university community. For me, writing this is far more than fulfilling a formal recommendation. It is a heartfelt thank you for the transformative role he has played in my life.

What always stood out about Dr. Veksler was how practical he made learning computer science. Drawing directly from his real-world experience in the field, he went beyond theoretical concepts to show us how software engineering actually functions in practice. At the same time, he constantly pushed us toward innovation and gave us true ownership over our work. He taught us how to strip away unnecessary complexity and solve problems in an intuitive, simple way, which is a mindset that laid the foundation for how I approach challenges every single day and continues to be immensely beneficial in my job today.

His dedication to progress is evident not only in the classroom, but across the entire department. Whether through his initiative in creating tools like the LectureSeats website to reimagine student attendance, or establishing the C-STEM and CogAI research lab to foster genuine research and hands-on innovation, Dr. Veksler constantly builds systems that elevate those around him. What makes this work so effective is his intentional approach to organization, where he skilfully leverages different digital tools, workflows, and systems to his advantage, allowing him to manage multiple complex projects and department responsibilities without ever compromising on quality or student accessibility. Beyond his exceptionally crafted lectures and slides, what truly resonated with me was his character. He didn't just teach computer science through coursework; he led by example and showed us through how he lived and worked what it means to be a good professional and a good person.

Dr. Veksler created an environment where students always felt supported. His genuine availability and helping attitude made him incredibly easy to approach, no matter how complex the topic or how unconventional an idea might have seemed. I never had to hesitate or worry that my thoughts would be dismissed; instead, every conversation was an opportunity to learn, iterate, and refine.

Most importantly, Dr. Veksler's guidance was never limited to just passing the next assignment or getting through the semester. He consistently encouraged me to think about my long-term future, preparing me for my career and life ahead of me. The mindset, confidence, and problem-solving framework I took from his classroom are things I will carry with me throughout my entire professional journey.

Dr. Veksler's leadership, academic rigor, and unwavering dedication embody the core mission of Caldwell University. Promoting him acknowledges his substantial contributions to the department and ensures future students continue to benefit from his exceptional mentorship.

I wholeheartedly support Dr. Veksler's advancement and tenure without a slight reservation. Please feel free to contact me if you require any further context regarding my experience under his instruction.

Sincerely,

Nathan Ayele  
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